

VTU MBA — Human Resource Management

Question Bank & Module-Wise Question Analysis (2023, 2024, 2025 Examination Papers)

Course Code: 22MBA21 / MBA201

Modules: 1 to 6

Combined & Consolidated

About This Consolidated Question Bank

This document combines and synthesizes all question paper items from **June/July 2023, June/July 2024, and June/July 2025** VTU Examinations for MBA 2nd Semester Human Resource Management. Identical/similar questions from multiple years are consolidated with full historical appearance notes, marks allocation, and Bloom's levels. At the end, a dedicated section outlines **Most Repeated Questions & Exam Predictions for 2026**.

MODULE 1: Introduction to Human Resource Management

Syllabus Coverage: Definition, Nature, Scope, Importance, Evolution, Functions, Principles, HRM vs Personnel Management, Models of HRM (Harvard, Guest, etc.), HR Competencies, HRM and Firm Performance.

QUESTION & DETAILS	MARKS	EXAM YEAR(S) & FREQUENCY
1. What is Human Resource Management? / Importance of HRM - What is Human Resource Management? (2025) - Why is Human Resource Management important for organizations? (2023)	3 Marks	2023 (Q1a) 2025 (Q1a) ★ Repeated (2 Times)
2. Differences between Personnel Management and HRM Differentiate among / between Human Resource Management and Personnel Management.	7 Marks	2024 (Q1b) 2025 (Q3b) ★ Repeated (2 Times)
3. Principles of Human Resource Management State / Discuss the core principles of Human Resource Management.	3 Marks (2024) 7 Marks (2025)	2024 (Q1a) 2025 (Q6b) ★ Repeated (2 Times)
4. Models of HRM (Harvard Model & Guest Model) - Explain the Harvard model of HRM. (10 Marks - 2023) - Discuss the Guest Model and Harvard model of HRM. (10 Marks - 2024)	10 Marks	2023 (Q1c) 2024 (Q7c) ★ Core Theoretical Topic
5. Functions of Human Resource Management - Outline the managerial and operative functions of HRM. (10M - 2024) - Discuss various functions of Human Resource Management. (10M - 2025)	10 Marks	2024 (Q1c) 2025 (Q7c) ★ Repeated (2 Times)
6. Evolution of Human Resource Thought Write a note on the evolution of human resource thought.	7 Marks	2023 (Q1b)
7. Human Resource Competencies Explain the various Human Resource Competencies required in modern organizations.	7 Marks	2025 (Q2b)
8. Changing Role & Responsibilities of HR Professionals Elaborate on the changing role and responsibilities of HR professionals in today's changing environment.	7 Marks	2023 (Q2b)

MODULE 2: HR Planning, Recruitment, Selection, Training & Development

Syllabus Coverage: HRP Importance, Process, Tools, Barriers; Job Analysis (JD & JS); Job Evaluation; Recruitment Sources & Advertisements; Selection Process & Tests; Training Methods (On-the-job & Off-the-job).

QUESTION & DETAILS	MARKS	EXAM YEAR(S) & FREQUENCY
1. HR Planning Concept, Process & Barriers - What is HRP? What are its uses? (3M - 2023) - State the barriers to HR planning. (3M - 2024) - What is HR planning? Briefly explain HR planning process. (7M - 2024)	3 Marks / 7 Marks	2023 (Q2a) 2024 (Q2a) 2024 (Q7b) ★ Repeated (3 Times)
2. Job Analysis, Job Description & Job Specification - What is Job Analysis? (3M - 2025) - Explain the Job analysis process along with its outcome Job description and Job specification. (7M - 2024)	3 Marks / 7 Marks	2024 (Q2b) 2025 (Q2a) ★ Repeated (2 Times)
3. Employee Selection Process & Methods - Sketch a neat diagram of selection process and explain it. (10M - 2024) - What is selection? Discuss different selection methods. (7M - 2023) - Explain the steps involved in Employee selection process. (10M - 2025)	7 Marks / 10 Marks	2023 (Q3b) 2024 (Q2c) 2025 (Q2c) ★ Core Topic (All 3 Years)
4. Sources of Recruitment & Practical Ad Design - Unsolicited applicants definition (3M - 2023) - Sources of recruitment in organization (7M - 2025) - Design recruitment advertisement for automobile firm in Pune (10M - 2023)	3M / 7M / 10M	2023 (Q3a, Q3c) 2025 (Q5b)
5. Training Methods (On-the-Job and Off-the-Job) Discuss on-the-job and off-the-job training methods.	10 Marks	2025 (Q4c)
6. Job Evaluation Methods Discuss the different methods of job evaluation.	10 Marks	2023 (Q2c)

MODULE 3: Compensation, Performance Management & Industrial Relations

Syllabus Coverage: Total Compensation & Rewards, Pay Structures, Performance Appraisal vs PMS, Rating Methods, Decent Workplace (ILO), Industrial Relations (Objectives, Approaches, Actors, Trade Unions).

QUESTION & DETAILS	MARKS	EXAM YEAR(S) & FREQUENCY
1. Performance Appraisal Methods & PMS Comparison • Differentiate between performance appraisal and PMS (10M - 2023) • Elaborate traditional and modern methods of performance rating (10M - 2024) • Explain the methods of Performance Appraisal system (10M - 2025)	10 Marks	2023 (Q4c) 2024 (Q3c) 2025 (Q3c) ★ Core Topic (All 3 Years)
2. Compensation, Pay Structure & Total Rewards System • Give the meaning of compensation and benefits. (3M - 2024) • Explain the components of total reward system. (7M - 2023) • Discuss the components of pay structure in India. (7M - 2025)	3 Marks / 7 Marks	2023 (Q4b) 2024 (Q3a) 2025 (Q1b) ★ Repeated (All 3 Years)
3. Industrial Relations (Objectives, Approaches & Actors) • Explain the approaches of Industrial relations systems. (7M - 2024) • Mention / Who were the Actors in Industrial Relations? (3M - 2024, 2025) • State any three Objectives of Industrial Relations. (3M - 2025)	3 Marks / 7 Marks	2024 (Q3b, Q7a) 2025 (Q3a, Q6a) ★ Repeated (2 Years)
4. Trade Unions (Definition & Reasons for Joining) • What do you mean by Trade union? (3M - 2025) • Explain various reasons for employees to join trade union. (10M - 2025)	3 Marks / 10 Marks	2025 (Q6c, Q7a)
5. Decent Workplace (ILO Standards) Mention important factors in a decent workplace as per ILO.	3 Marks	2023 (Q4a)

MODULE 4: HRM in SMEs & Service Sector

Syllabus Coverage: MSME Definition in India, Importance & HR Challenges in SMEs, Differences in Adoption, Service Sector vs Manufacturing Sector, Benefits & Significance of Service Sector.

QUESTION & DETAILS	MARKS	EXAM YEAR(S) & FREQUENCY
1. Manufacturing Sector vs Service Sector Comparison Bring out the differences between / among Service sector and Manufacturing sector.	3 Marks (2025) 7 Marks (2023, 2024)	2023 (Q6b) 2024 (Q4b) 2025 (Q4a) ★ Repeated (All 3 Years)
2. MSME / SME Definitions & Importance - Define SMEs / MSME in India. (3M - 2023, 2024) - Illustrate on the importance of SMEs in developing countries. (7M - 2023)	3 Marks / 7 Marks	2023 (Q5a, Q5b) 2024 (Q4a) ★ Repeated (2 Years)
3. HR Challenges & Adoption Factors in SMEs - Discuss the HR challenges faced by SMEs. (10M - 2023) - Discuss factors influencing adoption of HRM practices in SMEs. (7M - 2025)	7 Marks / 10 Marks	2023 (Q5c) 2025 (Q7b) ★ Repeated (2 Years)
4. Benefits & Significance of Service Sector Outline the benefits and significance of Service sector to the economy and HR.	10 Marks	2024 (Q4c)

MODULE 5: HR Innovations & Human Resource Information Systems (HRIS)

Syllabus Coverage: HR Innovations Concept, Factors affecting innovation, Innovative HR practices in India, Implementation conditions, HRIS concept, benefits, limitations & digital age.

QUESTION & DETAILS	MARKS	EXAM YEAR(S) & FREQUENCY
1. HR Innovations & Innovative HR Practices in India • What are HR Innovations? (3M - 2024) • Discuss any 3 innovative HR practices followed in Indian organizations. (7M - 2023) • Discuss innovative Human Resource practices in India. (10M - 2025) • Discuss conditions necessary for HR implementation. (10M - 2023)	3M / 7M / 10M	2023 (Q6c, Q7b) 2024 (Q5a) 2025 (Q1c) ★ Repeated (All 3 Years)
2. Human Resource Information Systems (HRIS) What is HRIS? Explain its benefits and limitations.	7 Marks	2025 (Q4b)
3. Factors Affecting Innovation Process in Organisations Explain the factors affecting the innovation process in organization.	7 Marks	2024 (Q5b)

MODULE 6: Future Trends in Human Resource Management

Syllabus Coverage: Hybrid Work Model, People Analytics, Multi-generational Workforces, Diversity & Inclusion, Gen Y / Gen Z, Internal Mobility, Gamification, All-in-One HR Tools.

QUESTION & DETAILS	MARKS	EXAM YEAR(S) & FREQUENCY
1. Multi-Generational Workforces & Gen Y Features • Unique features of Gen Y workforce. (3M - 2023) • Explain the benefits of Multi-generational workforces. (10M combined - 2024) • Explain multi-generational workforce. (10M - 2025)	3 Marks / 10 Marks	2023 (Q7a) 2024 (Q6c) 2025 (Q5c) ★ Repeated (All 3 Years)
2. Hybrid Work Model in HRM Briefly explain the hybrid work model of HRM. State its advantages and disadvantages.	7 Marks	2024 (Q6b)
3. Diversity and Inclusion in Organizations Discuss the importance of diversity and inclusiveness in organizations.	10 Marks	2023 (Q7c)
4. People Analytics & All-in-One HR Tools • Meaning of People Analytics (3M - 2024) • All-in-One HR tools concept (2024) • Current trends in Human Resource Management (10M - 2024)	3 Marks / 10 Marks	2024 (Q5c, Q6a, Q6c)
5. Internal Mobility & Gamification • What is Internal Mobility? (3M - 2025) • What is your understanding of the term "Gamification"? (3M - 2023)	3 Marks	2023 (Q6a) 2025 (Q5a)

COMPULSORY CASE STUDIES (Question No. 8 — 20 Marks Each)

Summary of Compulsory 20-Mark Case Studies from 2023, 2024, and 2025 Exam Papers.

1. June/July 2025 (MBA201): Sumit Private Ltd — Workplace Equity vs Internal Mobility

Scenario: Sumit Ltd provides identical benefits/uniforms for all levels, but faces operational errors (mismatched packaging, late dispatches). HR investigation revealed morale drop due to hiring external candidates for senior roles with higher pay, bypassing loyal internal staff.

Questions Asked (5M × 4): (a) Core issue faced? (b) Why casual approach by staff? (c) How equality was maintained & limitations? (d) Suggested HR measures?

2. June/July 2024 (22MBA21): Academic Conflict & Workplace Politics Case Study

Scenario: Mr. Ram Sharma (36-year-old popular novelist) joined PhD in Telugu. Professors harbored jealousy over his fame, creating hurdles and stating he won't get his degree despite his hard work.

Questions Asked (5M × 4): (a) Actual conflict Sharma underwent? (b) Solution analysis? (c) How to overcome problem? (d) Who is wrong & justification?

3. June/July 2023 (22MBA21): Aleetek Shoes — Selection Criteria & Job Hopping Dilemma

Scenario: Footwear company expanding production screened candidates and found qualified candidates had frequent job changes. Traditional policy rejects candidate job hoppers, but rejecting them risks candidate shortage while hiring them risks turnover.

Questions Asked (10M × 2): (a) Comment on company's HR policy. (b) Recommendations to management.

MOST REPEATED QUESTIONS & HIGH PROBABILITY PREDICTIONS FOR THIS YEAR

Based on frequency analysis across 2023, 2024, and 2025 VTU examination papers, the following topics are highest priority for upcoming exam preparation:

1. Performance Appraisal vs. Performance Management System (PMS) & Rating Methods [Module 3]

Frequency: 100% (Appeared in 2023, 2024, and 2025 as 10-Mark questions).

High Probability Prediction: Expect a 10-mark question on traditional vs. modern methods of performance appraisal (360-degree, BARS, MBO) or a comparison between PA and PMS.

2. Selection Process & Recruitment Sources [Module 2]

Frequency: 100% (Appeared in all 3 exam cycles).

High Probability Prediction: 10-mark diagrammatic explanation of the selection process OR practical recruitment advertisement design / sources of recruitment.

3. Service Sector vs. Manufacturing Sector Differences [Module 4]

Frequency: 100% (Appeared in 2023, 2024, and 2025).

High Probability Prediction: 7-mark or 3-mark direct question on distinction between service and manufacturing sector HRM and significance of service sector.

4. Innovative HR Practices & HR Innovations [Module 5]

Frequency: 100% (Appeared in 2023, 2024, and 2025).

High Probability Prediction: 7 or 10-mark question asking to explain 3-4 innovative HR practices in Indian companies (e.g., wellness programs, gamification, AI hiring).

5. Multi-Generational Workforces & Future Trends [Module 6]

Frequency: 100% (Appeared in 2023, 2024, and 2025).

High Probability Prediction: 10-mark question on managing Gen Y / Gen Z workforces, Hybrid Work Models, or People Analytics.

6. Models of HRM (Harvard Model & Guest Model) [Module 1]

Frequency: Repeated in 2023 and 2024 (10 Marks).

High Probability Prediction: Detailed 10-mark question on Harvard Model vs. Guest Model or Functions/ Principles of HRM.

7. HR Planning (HRP) Process & Job Analysis (JD & JS) [Module 2]

Frequency: Repeated across 2023, 2024, and 2025.

High Probability Prediction: 7-mark question on HRP steps, barriers, or Job Analysis outcomes (Job Description vs Job Specification).